Research Associate, Centre for Civil Society

Centre for Civil Society (CCS) is recruiting a Research Associate to work on research initiatives on governance reforms in education, ease of doing business, environment, and livelihood.

ABOUT CENTRE FOR CIVIL SOCIETY

CCS is an independent public policy think tank based in New Delhi. Our work in education, livelihood, and policy training promotes choice and accountability across private and public sectors. To translate policy into practice, we engage with policy and opinion leaders through research, pilot projects and advocacy.

Over the last many years, CCS' research team has built a reputation for shining light on the dark recesses of governance: collecting and analysing data through primary surveys, public datasets and administrative data, and RTI applications, compiling legal and legislative analysis; testing the validity of innovative governance tools through pilot projects; and proposing a redesign of existing regulatory frameworks.

Examples of our research outputs

- In 2021, we studied the school reimbursement process under the Right to Education Act 2009, including an extensive review of existing research, analysis of the law and economics behind reimbursements, stakeholder perceptions, and High Court judgements pertaining to the implementation of Section 12(2)
- In 2021, we studied policies that impact the international trade in agriculture markets.
- In 2021, we conducted a process audit of 26 services across 5 departments in Punjab.
- In 2019 we studied the regulatory interface between government and private schools by analysing administrative data on licensing, fee regulation and inspections to understand the challenges of starting and operating private schools in northern India.
- In 2020, 2019 and 2017, we brought out Street Vendors Act - Compliance Index Reports tracking the implementation of Street Vendors Act 2014 across states.
- Over the years, we have produced over 150 research papers on the challenges facing micro, small and medium entrepreneurs and issues in education governance using observational studies and primary data collection.

In education, we focus on increasing school choice and improving governance, particularly the uncoupling of service delivery, financing and regulatory functions of the government. Our work on livelihoods is directed towards fostering greater economic freedom and improving the ease of doing business for micro, small and medium enterprises. In addition, CCS runs projects on environment, agriculture and a pan-India assessment of regulatory quality.

Centre for CIVIL SOCIETY
SOCIAL CHANGE THROUGH PUBLIC POLICY

ROLE PROFILE

Research Associates at CCS have sharp analytical and critical thinking abilities, and curiosity about the interplay between government, citizens, markets and civil society. An ideal team member is energetic, proactive, able to work independently and collaboratively as needed, and possesses both integrity and the humility to seek advice when needed. The Associate should be passionate about working on governance reforms**.**

As a Research Associate, you will collaborate on and lead projects in our areas of interest and will partner with the advocacy team to effectively disseminate outputs from our research to elected representatives, policy makers, media and other important stakeholders.

Responsibilities

- Undertake primary and secondary research projects independently or collaboratively with other members of the research team
    - Collate and analyse data collected through primary research, case studies, literature reviews, pilot projects, and publicly available datasets
    - Ensure that data collected through research tools are complete, accurate and comprehensive
    - Create powerful infographics and visualise data
    - Conduct quick research across the lines of market scan for need-based work
- Produce high-quality research outputs of different lengths and for different audiences: academic papers, short policy briefs, blogs etc
- Assume responsibilities for project planning, data collection, analysis and documentation
- Deliver projects within agreed timelines, keeping in mind the quality and impact indicators set for the team
- Help select external parties for projects and coordinate with them for implementation of timelines and ensuring proper direction of the work.
- Remain current on developments in CCS' areas of work
    - Monitor, analyse, and report on emerging policy and research issues by regularly reviewing relevant sources
    - Maintain knowledge of government policy decisions
- Partner with the communication and advocacy teams to
    - Disseminate research findings to stakeholders in the policy making ecosystem, including the media
    - Support dialogues, workshops, and conferences on research outputs
    - Write opinion pieces and commentaries on research undertaken and contemporary issues for newspapers, journals ,and other relevant publications

CANDIDATE QUALIFICATIONS

Experience and education

- Associate: Minimum Bachelors; MA/MSc Economics/Statistics/Political Science/Political Economy/Public Policy/ Law (desirable, not necessary)

- Proficiency in at least one of the following research skills:
    - Running primary surveys (questionnaire design and digital data collection), response coding, and analysis of quantitative responses
    - Working with large datasets (eg. NSSO, CMIE's household or firm data, Government of India's U-DISE raw data)
    - Working with government administrative data (IT system logs, inspection reports, grievance logs, etc)
    - Conducting case studies, by studying a subsection of an issue in depth and conducting qualitative stakeholder interviews.
- Demonstrated proficiency in high-quality succinct error-free writing in English
- Proficiency in Microsoft powerpoint and excel
- Published academic research at a bachelor's level at least (academic papers, reports, blogs in own name etc)

Skills and Competencies

- Ability to articulate research content to varying audiences in English;
- Proficiency in reading and writing in Hindi is a bonus
- Ability to think through problems with clarity and deductive/inductive reasoning
- Ability to process vast amounts of information and generate useful insights quickly
- Ability to communicate ideas in a clear and concise manner and adapt messages to different interlocutors, including government partners, policy influencers, team members, researchers, partner organisations and donors.
- Knowledge of the Indian policy process and political landscape.

Attributes

- Liberal bent of mind, with a commitment to a safe working environment for team members
- Openness to ideas and debate
- Ambition to make an impact on the world and leave a mark, and not just to do a good enough job
- Ability to generate goodwill with working partners and resolve conflicts at the earliest through transparent communication
- Relentless pursuit of excellence, self-reflection, and commitment to honest feedback
- Deep comfort with an environment that prizes collaborative technologies (basecamp, g-drive, e-meet);

MORE DETAILS

Job Title

Associate, Research, Centre for Civil Society

Location

This role will be based out of CCS' office in Delhi.

Compensation

CCS recognises that the right candidate will have a significant impact on the success of the organization and will offer an attractive compensation package for the non-profit sector, commensurate with experience.